

Qualcomm's Snapdragon 8 Elite Gen 5 SoC

It will power the next generation of Android flagship phones

Qualcomm has unveiled its most powerful mobile platform yet – the Snapdragon 8 Elite Gen 5. This is the annual upgrade from Qualcomm which rivals Apple's A19 Pro chip and will power the next generation of Android flagship phones. The new chip brings more performance, efficiency and better on-device AI capabilities, shaping the future of smartphones.

Qualcomm showcased the upcoming chip to select media at a briefing on a reference device. The new chip score over 4.2 million AnTuTu, way more than the flagship chip from both Apple and MediaTek. Its Geekbench 6 and PCMark scores were also quite impressive.



At the heart of the new platform is the 3rd Gen Qualcomm Oryon CPU, which Qualcomm claims is the fastest mobile CPU ever, delivering a 20% boost in performance over its predecessor. Complementing it is a redesigned Qualcomm Adreno GPU, improving graphics performance by 23

and a Hexagon NPU with 37% faster AI processing. Together, these upgrades promise smoother multitasking, longer gaming sessions and highly efficient on-device intelligence.

"With Snapdragon 8 Elite Gen 5, you are at the center of your mobile experience," said Chris Patrick, senior vice president and general manager of mobile handsets at Qualcomm. "It enables personalized AI agents to see what you see, hear what you hear and think with you in real time."

For creators, the platform introduces a world first: Advanced Professional Video (APV) codec recording on mobile. Combined with AI-powered camera features, this allows for studio-grade video production and extensive post-production flexibility, further positioning smartphones as professional creative tools.

The Snapdragon 8 Elite Gen 5 will debut in flagship devices from leading OEMs and smartphone brands in the coming days. Mobile partners are gearing up for their respective launch.

Qualcomm says 6G devices by 2028, aims for AI everywhere

At the Snapdragon Summit in Maui, Qualcomm has made it clear that 6G technology will rollout sooner than you may think. Taking the stage on the very first day of the Summit, Qualcomm CEO Cristiano Amon announced that the company will begin testing the 6G tech in 2028 with pre-commercial devices, he said.

The other big theme of Amon's keynote was AI. He said that a new phase of Snapdragon will build around bringing AI everywhere.

"We are going to bring AI everywhere, leading the next generation of innovation," he said, while adding that AI will soon become the new user interface for devices.

Amon explained that AI will not remain confined to smartphones but will expand across PCs, wearables



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Cristiano Amon, President & CEO,
Qualcomm Inc.

and other connected devices. He described a world where each device functions as an intelligent "agent," working in sync with a user's smartphone to manage tasks which may range from scheduling conflicts to financial reminders.

According to Amon, AI models themselves will also evolve. Instead of relying solely on centralised cloud training, Qualcomm envisions a tiered system of edge-based models that can refine and

apply insights locally while still benefiting from large-scale training in the cloud.

That approach, he argued, will be necessary to handle the massive volumes of user data expected in the years ahead.